

7.4.4 Pedagogy and Assessment

The approach, principles, and methods of pedagogy and assessment have commonalities across subjects – those have been discussed in Part A, Chapter 3, §3.3 and §3.4 of this document. This section focusses only on what is most critical to The World Around Us. Hence, it will be useful to read this section along with the above-mentioned section.

7.4.4.1 Pedagogy for The World Around Us

Environment, for students in the Preparatory Stage, is what is immediately around them and affects their lives. Students learn about the environment through structured interaction with their natural and social environment, exploration, discussion of experiences and observations, interaction with adults and peers, exemplars, task-oriented activities, structured observations, experiments, surveys, and visits.

This engagement with the immediate environment provides a base for moving into exploring larger systems (from locality to district to region to state to nation to world), broader issues (from home to community to larger society), and an expanding understanding of concerns, connections, and consequences. Thus, students' engagement with their immediate environment leads them to an understanding of distant environments — they are able to apply their understanding from 'near' to 'far', and vice versa.

Values and dispositions — e.g., collaboration, respect for diversity, inclusion, scientific temper, sensitivity towards the social and natural environment are best developed if they are demonstrated — by adults in the school. Students must also get the opportunity to practise them in their interactions.

7.4.4.1.1 Pedagogical Approaches

Students' questions and experiences — related to the social and physical environment, and of social processes around them (including schools and family) — must be given space. This establishes trust and empathy between the Teacher and students.

Teachers need to help students develop conceptual understanding instead of accumulating facts. This implies that sufficient time must be provided for surveys, exploration, visits to institutions, excursions (including within the school campus), observation, experiments, simple inquiry, dialogue with Teachers and peers, role play, questioning, and the communication of ideas.

Task-oriented work, wherein they take up some small tasks, helps students connect learning to doing. Through the creation of simple models and toys, they can communicate their understanding and make learning concrete in the process. Allowing students to take the lead in material development, through a variety of modes like art and craft, story, drama, and hands-on experiments provides space for them to be involved in several small-scale and large-scale assignments and projects. This is also invaluable for the development of prevocational capacities.

Teachers must also be aware of values and dispositions that can be developed through activities, and plan deliberately to offer students experiences. They should also make the values and dispositions explicit for students by drawing attention to them. They should also make them explicit for students by drawing attention to specific values and dispositions (e.g., collaborative learning, developing a scientific temper, working in diverse groups, analysing work distribution at home, caring for the environment, cleanliness, standing in queues).

7.4.3 Content

The approach, principles, and methods of selecting content have commonalities across subjects — those have been discussed in **Part A, Chapter 3, §3.2** of this document. This section focusses only on what is most critical to The World Around Us. Hence, it will be useful to read this section along with the above-mentioned section.

7.4.3.1 Principles of Content Selection

The following principles will inform the selection of content for The World Around Us.

- a. Content selected must enable the development of essential process capacities (observation, making hypotheses, experimentation to test hypotheses, data collection and analysis, discussion). For example,
 - i. Assign tasks based on the natural curiosity of students with reference to specific questions/assumptions/hypotheses– they could be asked to observe and record the growth of plants from seeds under different conditions (in different kinds of soil, under different amounts of sunlight).
 - ii. Extend this experience to students' own lives and ask them to describe their observations and hypotheses on how crops/plants grow in pots. They can discuss the various uses of plants
 - iii. Organise visits to local markets, fairs, museum, and monuments, and share observations and experiences throughout the processes using different modes
 - iv. Conduct hands-on experiments to test hypotheses and make informed conclusions. Experiments can be conducted in groups to encourage collaboration, teamwork, and social interaction
- b. Content selected should enable maximum possible social interaction, and interaction with the natural environment. For example,
 - i. Identity and relationships within family and community; plants and animals; own body; geographical features; transportation and communication; local institutions; migration of families; different habits in different communities (food, practices, traditions); food habits and shelter of animals; various local traditional art forms; festivals and celebrations; community melas and marriage celebrations; day and night, time of sunrise and sunset, patterns; sun, moon, stars, and planets
- c. Content selected should reflect diversity and must be inclusive while developing sensitivity and breaking stereotypes. For example,

- i. Diversity of geographical characteristics, flora, and fauna around them
 - ii. Impact of hot weather or excessive rain on plants and animals
 - iii. Practices related to work especially with reference to gender – division of labour at home, food distribution in families, understanding the context of migrant labourers.
- d. Content must move from the local context to an understanding of social and natural environments beyond the immediate environment as students progress across grades.
 - i. Content should be contextual and related to the immediate environment in lower grades of this Stage.
 - ii. Gradually increasing exposure to other contexts through comparison and analogy is important — multiple geographies, genders, communities. For example, if the concept of ‘Transport’ has to be discussed, content can include the pictures in the textbook, discussion of modes of transport in the community, sharing of narratives of travel by students, local news reports related to transportation, instances of use of these roads by the local community, videos of modes of transport that are not available in the locality (e.g., understanding trains in a school in the upper Himalayas).
- e. Content selected should be such that it can be presented in multiple ways, which go beyond the textbook. For example, students should have the opportunity to explore the same content in various modes as indicated below:
 - i. Case studies
 - ii. Visual representation through pictures and simple maps
 - iii. Using ICT-based resources – videos to give evidence for discussions and/or support discussions on specific issues
 - iv. Poems, stories, plays, games, and news stories
 - v. Folklore, folk songs, oral histories, and oral narratives
 - vi. Visual art projects
 - vii. Building of models, scientific tinkering, and engaging in hands-on experiments to test hypotheses
- f. Environmental values and dispositions must be integrated in the content and should enable pedagogy that is not didactic/prescriptive. For example,
 - i. Judicious use of water
 - ii. Dignity of all living beings
 - iii. Impact of humans on the environment
 - iv. Needs of plants and animals
- g. Content must incorporate Indian knowledge and local culture. For example,
 - i. Food preservation
 - ii. Processes to conserve resources, including local wells and stepwells
 - iii. Local literature – alignment with contemporary knowledge, natural disasters, and human-nature conflicts